The Millennium

***Purpose**: To explain millennium and purpose – What happens during and after it.*

***Centred on**: The Goodness of God, seen at the cross is demonstrated in the Millennium Judgement.*

Three phases of judgement:

- Pre-advent Judgement (Investigative Judgement).
- Millennial Judgement.
- Executive Judgement.

John 5: 28-29…Here Jesus is giving insight to *two* resurrections.

Revelation 20: 4-6…In verse 4, we see the redeemed reign with Christ for a thousand years.

Critical thinking point: The author of Revelation was John and it must be noted that John's effective testimony for Christ led the Roman authorities to exile him to the small desolate island of Patmos in the Aegean Sea. This was a place where the Romans banished criminals and political offenders. Now John was a victim of the *false* judgement of man (people on thrones), so we can only imagine how content he must have felt when he envisioned this judgement scene of which the followers of Jesus were finally vindicated.

Now verse 5 mentions the rest of the dead (the lost), did not living again *until* the thousand years were finished.

So now we have an idea what the thousand years is all about:

- We know what starts the thousand years **(the second coming).**
- We know what the redeemed are doing (on the throne with Christ).
- We know what the wicked are doing (in the grave).

Verse 6 states first resurrection and second death….obviously there must be another resurrection and a first death.

Now let's take a look at what Satan's doing.

Revelation 19:11-21…Second coming of Christ, **the righteous dead are raised**, Jesus takes over then immediately after in Ch20 Satan is bound for 1000 years.

1 Thessalonians 4: 16-17… "The dead in Christ" (the just).

Question: According to this text, *when* does this resurrection take place?

Answer: The second coming (verse 16).

Now if Paul says that they rise *first*, by implication there must be another resurrection that rises *second.*

1 Cor 15:51-54…**The righteous living are transformed**. If this didn't happen at this moment how could we handle such a awesome moment….all the righteous dead being raised amongst kayos with the host of heaven in view etc….

Jeremiah 25:33…The **wicked will be destroyed** at the second coming. No one will be left here to mourn for them. (2 Thes 1:7-10)

Revelation 20: 1-3…**Can Satan *actually* be bound** with literal chains? Note: the chains prevent him from deceiving the nations until the expiration of the millennium. The chains are simply chains of circumstances and the circumstances are earth desolation (no one to deceive). The bottomless pit is the earth during the 1000 years.

The bottomless pit: The devil is cast into "the pit" (RSV), "the bottomless pit" (KJV), or the "abyss" (NASB, NIV). The Greek word abyssos, "abyss," appears in other NT passages as a place for evil spirits (Luke 8: 31) or the dwelling place of the dead (Rom 10: 7); it is also used in intertestamental Jewish literature for the place of punishment (1 Enoch 10: 4–6; Jubilees 5: 6–10). In Revelation 11: 7 and 17: 8 abyssos is the place from which the beast comes. The word used here is the same as that employed by the Septuagint (LXX), the original pre-Christian Greek translation of the Old Testament in Genesis 1: 2 to describe the chaotic situation of earth at Creation, when darkness was "upon the face of the deep." The earth reverts to chaos at the second advent of Christ and the beginning of the 1,000 years.

Condition of the earth during the millennium:

Jeremiah 4: 23-27…Note the term "without form and void." In *Genesis 1: 2*, we see the same term used (verbatim). In revelation 20 we have the earth in a condition where God is about to do something to it. He is about to recreate it! (Bottomless pit/abyss).

Note: A lot of the Old Testament writers use a duel prophecy approach. Many times when they spoke about judgements of particular nations that were locally present at that time, they would also apply this judgement prophecy to the end of time.

For example, in *Ezekiel 28* he is really speaking of the judgement of the king of Tyre, yet all of a sudden he starts speaking of Lucifer! A lot of the writers speak of specific kings/kingdoms and then they show the application to the great controversy. Another example is *Matthew 24* where Jesus is speaking of the destruction of Jerusalem but also uses this as a type/example of the destruction of the world.

Rev 20:4…During the 1000 years what is committed to the saints

1 Corinthians 6: 1-3…We will judge the world, we will even judge angels (Fallen angels).

We are essentially judging God! We will be granted the privilege of assessing the motives and intentions of God as well as the great lengths he went to redeem man. Before God resurrects any of the wicked, there will be no doubt as to whether or not God is Just. Remember, in the beginning of the great controversy, the accusation was laid down that God is a liar and desires to rule by force. Satan challenged the truthfulness of God's word by an unconcealed lie and essentially presented a different God, for this reason Christ was right in calling him the father of lies (John 8: 44). In essence, before God executes his wrath upon the wicked, he clears his decisions and his character with the redeemed.

1 Corinthians 4: 5…If we are to judge nothing *before* the time, then by implication we will be judging *after* the time (until the Lord comes). This phase of the judgement is very powerful because God brings to light the *hidden* things of darkness and *reveals* the counsels/motives of the heart. God wants us to be comfortable with what he has decided. Our perception of the world is shaped by the world because that is all we've ever known. (Family meeting #2)

Revelation 20: 7, 8, 5…**Satan will be released from his prison** (circumstance of desolation), upon the **resurrection of the wicked**. At this point, everyone that has ever lived will be alive to witness what is about to take place.

Revelation 21:2-8…**New Jerusalem descends**, the **wicked are finally destroyed** forever. Let's see also in the last chapter verse 20:9.

Revelation 20: 9… Notice in verse 9, where it stipulates the wicked will surround the saints and the beloved city. "And fire came down from God out of heaven and devoured them".

Revelation 21:1…**Earth is made new**.